

PRELIMINARY DATA: Assessment for Delta Operations on ESA and CESA-listed Osmerids

Last updated: *December 05, 2025*

Executive Summary

Section 3.13.3.4.1 of the Proposed Action and Section 8.1.4. of the Incidental Take Permit provide that during Old and Middle River (OMR) Management, the California Department of Water Resources, in coordination with Reclamation, shall provide State Water Project (SWP) and Central Valley Project (CVP) operational outlooks and assessments on a weekly basis to Water Operations Management Team (WOMT).

- OMR Season has not yet begun for Delta Smelt but First Flush could occur starting Dec 1
- Freeport flows and turbidity do not indicate First Flush will occur this week
- No Delta Smelt salvage has been observed this water year
- Two Delta smelt releases (hard truck, each 30,000 fish) are expected to occur on 12/2 and 12/3

Operational and Regulatory Conditions

- See current Weekly Fish and Water Operations Outlook document.
- Additional information also available on the [SacPAS SMT page](#).

Environmental Conditions

Weather Forecasts

- **Stockton, CA:**
 - No precipitation, high winds, or extreme temps expected. Temperature range is 41–59°F.
- **Antioch, CA:**
 - No precipitation, high winds, or extreme temps expected. Temperature range is 44–60°F.
- Weather forecasts for [Stockton, CA](#) and [Antioch, CA](#) as of December 05, 2025.

Delta Smelt

Biological

- **Delta Smelt Life Stages:** Adult
- **Abundance estimate:** 6550 (95% CL: 1,037 to 22,385) as of the week of November 17–21, 2025
- **Releases:** A total of 67,583 hatchery Delta Smelt have been released for WY 2026. The most recent releases of 67,583 fish occurred in Belden’s Landing boat ramp in Suisun Marsh on Nov 05, 2025 to Nov 04, 2025.
- **Delta Smelt count:** 2 adult Delta Smelt and 0 juvenile Delta smelt have been detected this water year. See Table 1 for recent detections, Figure 1 for spatial distribution, and Figure 2 for temporal distribution.
- **Delta Smelt salvage:** 0 Delta Smelt have been salvaged, and the cumulative seasonal salvage is 0.

Notes

- Since there are few recent detections of Delta Smelt, the Smelt Monitoring Team’s capacity to estimate where they are within the Delta is limited.
- See [SacPAS SMT Page](#) for additional details on releases and detection in surveys and salvage.
- Historical salvage trends can be found at: [SacPAS Salvage Timing](#)

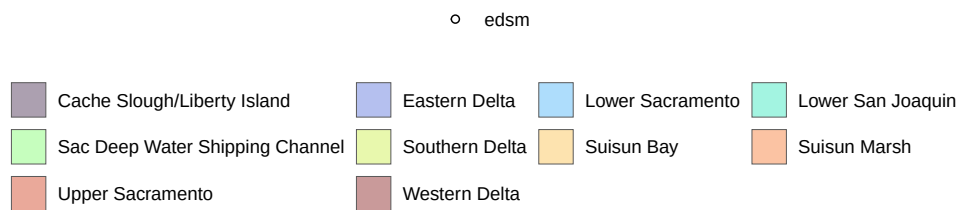
Table 1: Delta Smelt Detections in the last 2 weeks. Fork Length > 58mm = Adult, Fork Length 20-58mm = Juvenile, Fork Length < 20mm = Larva.

Survey	Date	Region	Stratum	Life Stage	Catch
edsm	2025-12-01	West	Suisun Marsh	Adult	1
edsm	2025-12-04	North	Sac DW Ship Channel	Adult	1

Table 2: Delta Smelt Water Year Totals by Life Stage

Survey	Region	Life Stage	Total
edsm	North	Adult	1
edsm	West	Adult	1

Environmental



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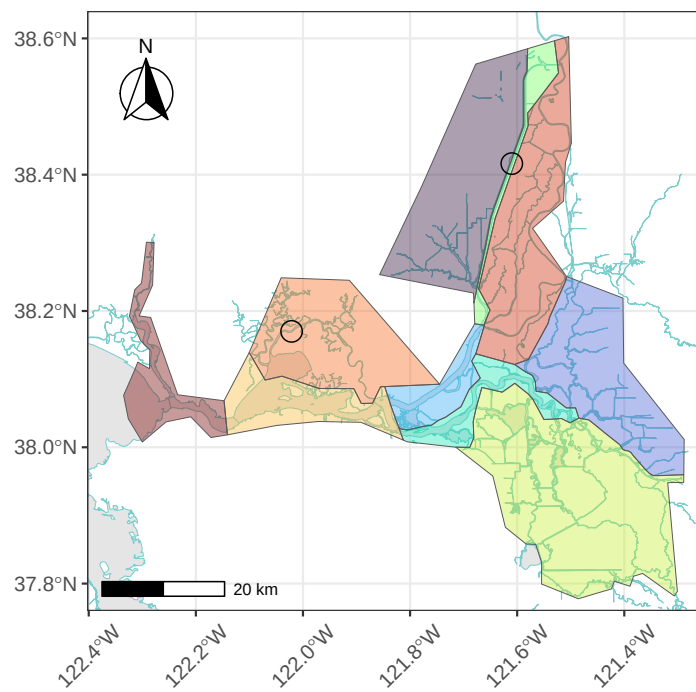


Figure 1: Delta Smelt Distribution for WY 2026

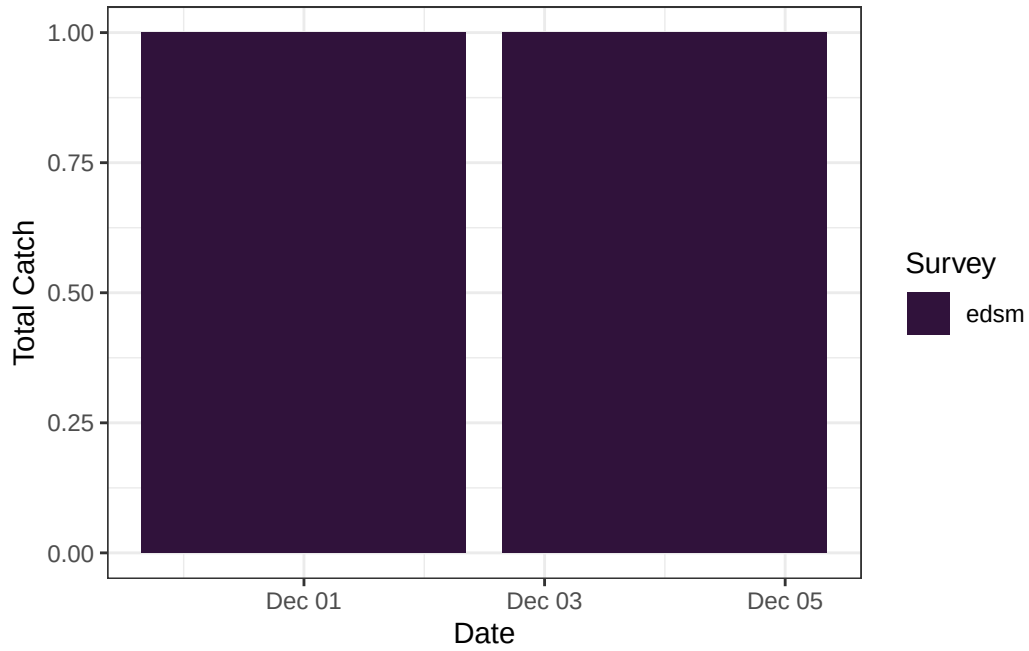
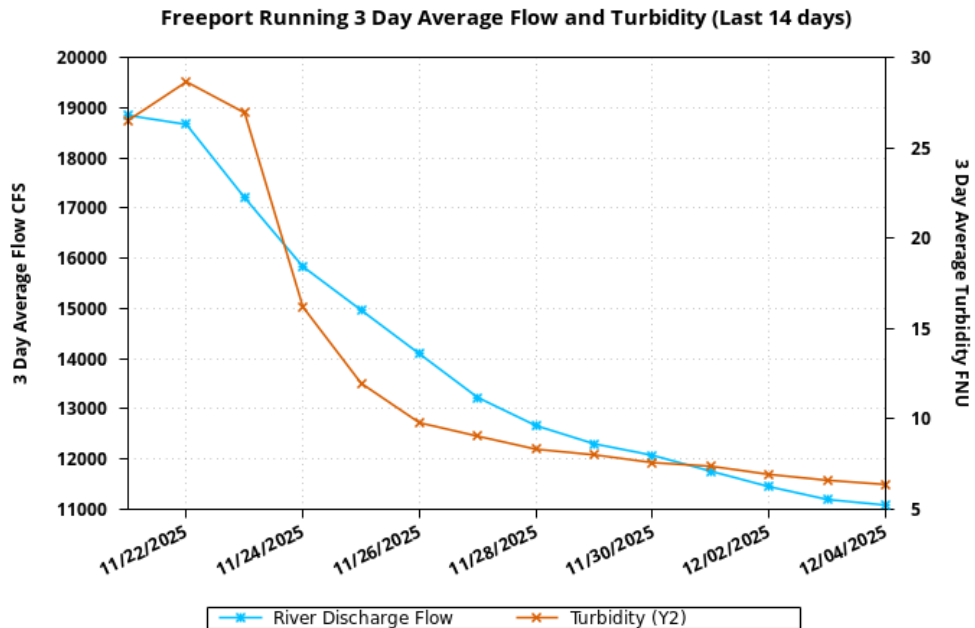


Figure 2: Time Series of Delta Smelt Catch, WY 2026

First Flush

Threshold: 3-day avg FPT flow 25,000 cfs and 3-day avg FPT turbidity 50 FNU

- **FPT Flow (3-day average):** 11085 cfs as of Dec 04, 2025
- **FPT Turbidity (3-day average):** 6.38 FNU as of Dec 04, 2025



Preliminary data from CDEC; subject to revision.

www.cbr.washington.edu/sacramento/
05 Dec 2025 12:35:01 PST

Adult Delta Smelt Entrainment Action

Add JPF later

- Not relevant
- See [Bay-Delta Live](#) for recent Delta-wide turbidity conditions.
- Let's link to wind plot on the other SacPAS SMT page. [Wind plot](#)

Larval/Juvenile Delta Smelt Entrainment Action

Currently Secchi depth; add JPF, South Delta turbidity and PTM later

- Not relevant

Longfin Smelt

Biological

- Longfin Smelt Life Stages: Juvenile

- **Longfin Smelt count:** 0 adult Longfin Smelt and 2 juvenile Longfin smelt have been detected this water year. See Table 3 for recent detections, Figure 3 for spatial distribution, and Figure 4 for temporal distribution.
- **Longfin Smelt salvage:** 0 Longfin Smelt have been salvaged, and the cumulative seasonal salvage is 0.
- Include plot of cumulative longfin salvage? [Salvage plot code](#)

Table 3: Longfin Smelt Detections in the last 2 weeks. Fork Length > 84mm = Adult, Fork Length 20-84mm = Juvenile, Fork Length < 20mm = Larva.

Survey	Date	Region	Stratum	Life Stage	Catch
edsm	2025-12-01	West	Suisun Marsh	Juvenile	2

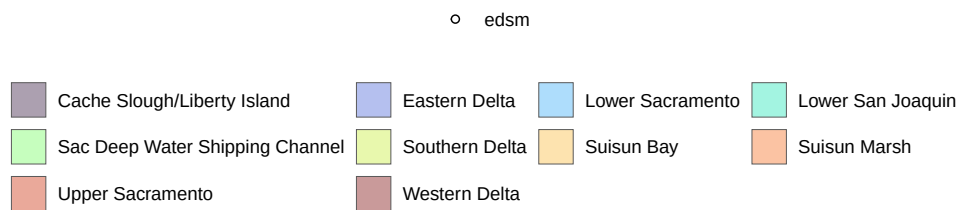
Table 4: Longfin Smelt Water Year Totals by Life Stage

Survey	Region	Life Stage	Total
edsm	West	Juvenile	2

Environmental

Adult Longfin Smelt Entrainment

- Jersey Point Flow:
 - Threshold: JPF < 0 cfs
 - Reclamation and DWR would compute JPF based on San Joaquin River Inflow at Vernalis, Cosumnes River Inflow, Mokelumne River Inflow, Calaveras River Inflow, Flow from Sacramento River through DCC, Flow from Sacramento River through Georgiana Slough, 65% of in-Delta precipitation, -65% of in-Delta diversions, and -Export Pumping at (Banks + Jones).
- Longfin Smelt salvage of age 1+ Longfin Smelt:
 - Threshold for OMR Season Start: 5% FMWT Index + 1
 - Threshold for Real-time: 5% Adult population abundance



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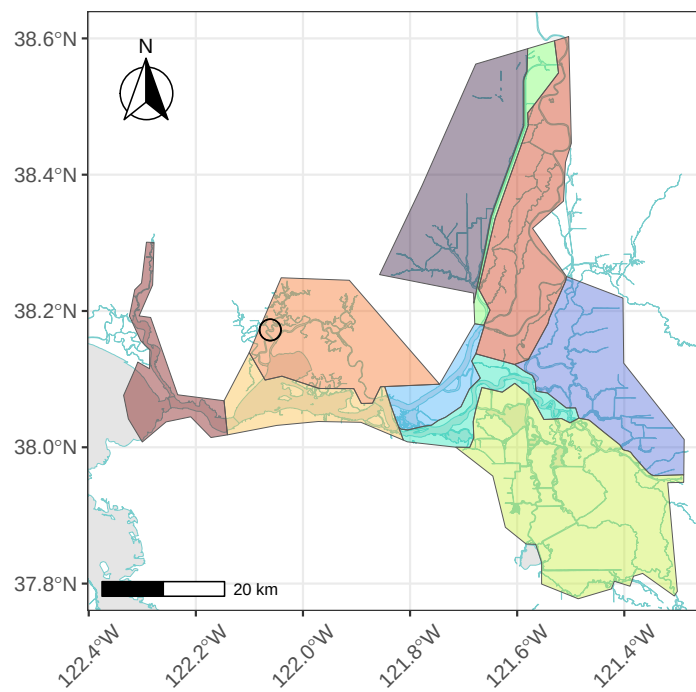


Figure 3: Longfin Smelt Distribution for WY 2026

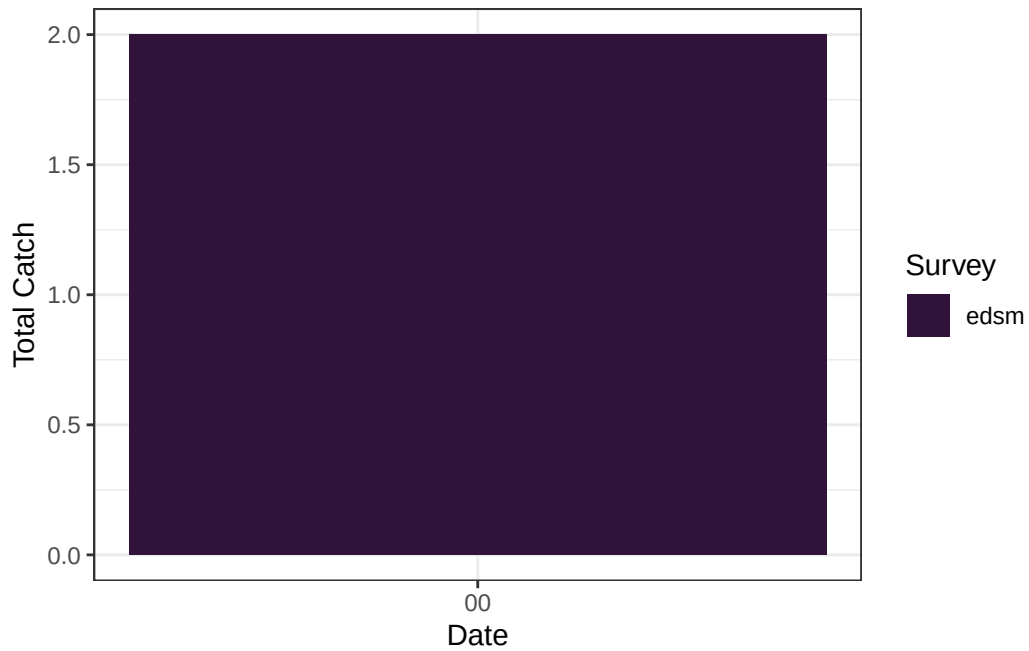


Figure 4: Time Series of Longfin Smelt Catch, WY 2026

Larval/Juvenile Longfin Smelt Entrainment

- Jersey Point Flow:
 - Threshold: $JPF < 0$ cfs
- Population model demonstrates need to reduce entrainment to avoid population decline

End of Smelt OMR Management

- Not relevant

References